

Scott Buonomo

OPERATIONS LEADERSHIP | SITE OPERATIONS | EVENTS | VENDOR MANAGEMENT

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Operations leader with 20+ years managing complex, high-visibility, multi-site service and event environments across higher education, cultural institutions, and hospitality venues. Proven track record building SOPs, leading teams, controlling costs, managing vendors, and coordinating cross-functional stakeholders to keep operations running smoothly. Brings calm execution, strong judgment, and hands-on leadership in fast-paced settings where service, safety, and readiness matter.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Operations & Site Management: Multi-site operations, SOP development, workflow optimization, facilities coordination, operational readiness, event support

Leadership & Collaboration: Team leadership, stakeholder engagement, union labor relations, cross-functional coordination, training and performance management

Financial & Vendor Oversight: Budget management, cost control, forecasting, procurement, contract oversight, vendor governance

Compliance & Systems: Compliance management, food safety, process improvement, technology implementation, reporting and performance tracking

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Columbia University | University Event Management — New York, NY

General Manager | May 2017 – Present

Lead day-to-day operations across multiple dining, event, and service venues with both union and non-union employees and multiple managers, scaling the organization from a single-site model to a coordinated multi-outlet operation.

- Direct daily operations across retail dining, catering, pantry, and event support functions, ensuring consistent execution in a high-expectation, guest-facing environment.
- Created and standardized SOPs and governance structures that improved accountability, service consistency, and team coordination across multiple operating areas.
- Own P&L and budget planning across service lines; monitor spending, control labor and operating costs, and identify savings opportunities through planning and workflow redesign.
- Lead vendor governance and procurement activity, including quarterly business reviews, contract performance oversight, and KPI management.
- Partner with facilities, culinary, and university stakeholders on operational readiness, asset lifecycle planning, sustainability, and compliance initiatives.
- Coordinate client walkthroughs, site visits, and event logistics, aligning staffing, space readiness, and service delivery with event requirements.
- Implemented technology and reporting improvements that reduced operational friction and improved visibility for faster decision-making.

Harvard Club of New York City | New York, NY

Multi-Outlet Food and Beverage Manager | December 2014 – May 2017

Directed operations across five dining venues within a historic private club, balancing high-touch member service with financial discipline and workforce leadership.

- Managed day-to-day operations across five distinct outlets, ensuring consistent standards, staffing coverage, and smooth execution across varied service models.

- Oversaw budgets, purchasing, and cost controls while maintaining strong service performance and member experience.
- Led unionized teams in a complex labor environment, with responsibility for scheduling, performance expectations, training, and compliance.
- Developed and implemented training programs covering service standards, product knowledge, and operational procedures.
- Supported strategic planning and cross-department coordination to align operations with institutional priorities and event needs.

East Coast Saloons | Spring Lake Heights, NJ

General Manager | June 2012 – December 2014

Oversaw site selection, construction support, and operational launch of two high-volume restaurant and bar locations, building the operating foundation from the ground up.

- Managed pre-opening activities including vendor selection, procurement, menu development, systems implementation, and operational policy design.
- Established staffing models and training programs that supported service consistency, cost control, and long-term performance.
- Led private and corporate event logistics, coordinating teams and resources to deliver successful guest experiences.

New Jersey Performing Arts Center | Culinaire Intl | Newark, NJ

Opening General Manager, Restaurant | June 2010 – May 2012

Built and launched restaurant operations within a major performing arts center, supporting opening readiness in a live-event cultural environment.

- Recruited, trained, and led the opening team while establishing operating procedures for a new restaurant inside a 2,800-seat performance venue.
- Managed budgets, financial models, inventory controls, and reporting across revenue centers to support sustainable operations after launch.
- Coordinated with institutional stakeholders to align service delivery with event activity, audience flow, and venue priorities.

The Metropolitan Museum of Art | New York, NY

Wine & Spirits Director / À la Carte Dining Manager | 2006 – 2010

Managed high-end dining operations and beverage program strategy within one of New York's premier cultural institutions.

- Directed operations, staff scheduling, and cost control in a fast-paced, high-service environment.
- Led beverage procurement, curation, and inventory management while maintaining service standards in a high-profile guest setting.
- Collaborated with finance and operations partners on reporting, forecasting, and day-to-day execution.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

Associate of Science, Culinary Arts | The Culinary Institute of America, Hyde Park, NY | 2005

Certifications: TIPS, ServSafe, ServSafe Alcohol

Systems: Microsoft Office Suite, POS Systems (MICROS), financial and inventory management tools